be shown the door at the next election. He would never show the courage that Golda showed in 1974 and resign. The whole government is a bunch of freaks, but at this moment the country has no choice but to keep them.

The number of Israelis killed has climbed to 700 and is expected to rise, as is the figure of more than 2,200 wounded. And at least 130 Israelis have been taken hostage, among them, let me stress, small children, elderly people, and men and women of all ages. The parents and relatives of the hostages are on the radio and on television at all hours and have yet to receive any answer, any news, any support from an official source. Not a syllable. They cry, they implore the government for answers, but no word comes. Nothing.

In all likelihood, Iran helped Hamas to prepare the onslaught, as China may have helped the Vietcong to launch the Tet Offensive that changed the course of the Vietnam War in 1968. It is unlikely that the military balance between Israel and Hamas will be changed, but the course of events in the Middle East seems to be on the brink of modification. This explains the strong US support of Israel. An entire carrier strike group has been ordered close to Israel's shores, and various types of military aid are being dispatched. Of course, Biden's sympathy for Israel plays a role. But what is more decisive than sympathy is the stand against a probable front in the region, as elsewhere, of Iran, Russia, and possibly China.

Netanyahu spoke and said nothing: "We will break their bones …"

Sunday, October 8

Even on Yom Kippur in 1973, the assault against Israel was less brutal and horrific than now. In the midst of this total chaos, official sources have remained silent, either as "policy" or, more plausibly, as a manifestation of their embarrassment about their complete lack of any preparation—or, perhaps even more damning, the absolute failure of these so-called